

North Hills Medical Group

6978 Maddox Wall, Monroeville, PA 15146
Phone: 878-555-9075 Fax: 724-555-6118

May 9, 2026

Steel City Cardiology Associates
200 Smithfield St, Pittsburgh, PA 15222
Re: Cardiology Referral — Echocardiogram (TTE)

Patient Information

Name	Tamara Higgins
Date of Birth	1970-10-04
Phone	412-555-5947
Address	374 Jackson Rest Greensburg, PA, 15601
MRN	MRN-496631

Insurance

Primary Payer	Cigna
Primary Member #	U531003309

Reason for Referral

This 55-year-old male presents with progressive dyspnea over the past three months, initially exertional but now occurring with minimal activity and at rest. He reports associated orthopnea, PND, and lower extremity edema. The patient has a significant past medical history including HTN managed with lisinopril and amlodipine, and remote tobacco use. He denies chest pain, palpitations, or syncope. Family history is notable for early CAD in a first-degree relative.

On examination today, vital signs reveal BP 148/92 and HR 88 regular. Cardiac auscultation demonstrates an S3 gallop with no murmurs appreciated. Lung bases show bibasilar crackles. Significant bilateral lower extremity pitting edema is present. JVD is elevated at approximately 8 cm. The clinical presentation is consistent with decompensated heart failure, and we need to assess left ventricular systolic and diastolic function to guide further management.

I am requesting a transthoracic echocardiogram to evaluate LV ejection fraction, wall motion abnormalities, diastolic parameters, and right ventricular function. This study will help establish the etiology of his cardiomyopathy and determine whether systolic dysfunction, diastolic dysfunction, or both are contributing to his presentation. Results will inform decisions regarding ACE inhibitor optimization, beta-blocker initiation, and consideration of additional therapies. Please see this patient at your earliest convenience given his symptomatic status.

Requested Study & Coding

Requested Study	Echocardiogram (TTE)
CPT Code	93306
ICD-10 Code(s)	I42.9
Urgency	ROUTINE
Requested Follow-up	14 days

Sincerely,

Sherri Frazier, MD
NPI: 7871331501
North Hills Medical Group